



ExamEye

A silent witness for online exams.

What it does, how to set it up in five steps, and how to read what it records. Written for exam-centre staff and invigilators; no technical background needed.

1. What ExamEye is

ExamEye is a small add-on for the Chrome browser. While a candidate sits an online paper, it writes down what happens in the browser and saves the record, with screenshots, to a folder on the same machine. It is a recorder, not a gatekeeper: it never blocks anything.



It does

- Starts and stops on its own when the exam website opens and when the paper is submitted.
- Writes one line for every notable event, with the time.
- Takes a screenshot of the exam tab when something happens, and every few minutes regardless.
- Can photograph the whole screen while the candidate is away from Chrome.
- Produces a readable report with all screenshots at the end of every paper.



It never does

- Block a page, a key, or the candidate. Nothing is prevented, only recorded.
- Read or change the candidate's answers.
- Name other applications. It records that Chrome lost focus, not what was opened.
- Send anything anywhere. Every file stays on the exam machine.
- Need anyone to click anything during the paper, except one screen-share prompt for the candidate.

2. How it works

- 1 The paper opens.** The candidate lands on the exam start page.
- 2 Recording starts.** ExamEye recognises the address and arms itself. The toolbar icon shows a red 0.
- 3 Events and screenshots.** A tab switch, a copy, Chrome losing focus: each becomes a log line and, in most cases, a picture.
- 4 The paper is submitted.** The submit button, the result page, or a phrase on the "submitted" screen ends the recording. The last few minutes are still watched.
- 5 The folder is written.** Log, screenshots and a report land in Chrome's Downloads folder under `ExamEye`.

A paper that is never submitted still ends: after the maximum length set in the settings, or once the exam tab has been gone for a while.

3. What gets recorded

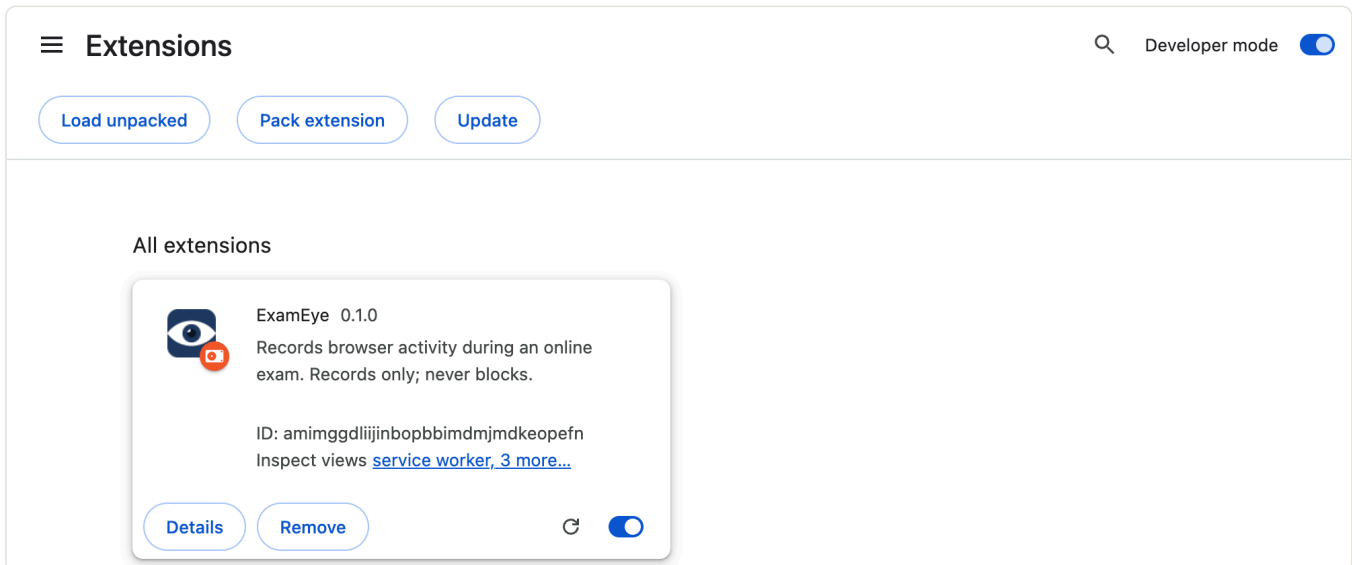
EVENT	WHAT IT MEANS	SCREENSHOT
Other tabs and pages	Switching to another tab, and which page it was	yes
Leaving Chrome	Another application came in front, and for how long	yes, plus a whole-screen frame when capture is on
Copy, cut, paste, print, drag out	Clipboard and print use on the exam page, with the length of the text	yes
Downloads	Any file the candidate downloads	yes
Window changes	Minimised, restored, full-screen left	on full-screen exit
Screen lock or idle	The screensaver, the lock screen, long inactivity	no
Developer tools	The browser's inspection panel being opened	yes
Settings changed mid-paper	Which ExamEye fields were changed	yes
Clock set back	The computer clock jumping backwards	no
Second monitor	More than one screen attached when capture starts	no
Routine	A picture of the exam tab at a fixed interval (10 minutes by default)	yes

4. Setup: five steps, once per machine

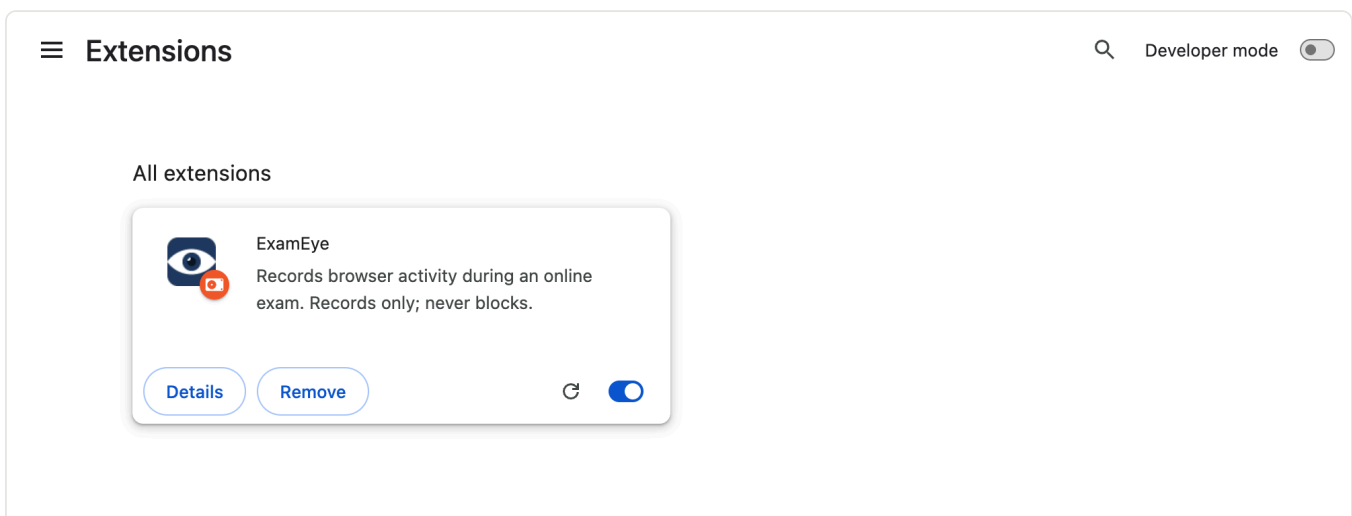
About twenty minutes including the dry run. After that there is nothing to click on exam day. On managed fleets IT can push ExamEye and its settings by policy instead of steps 1 to 3; ask before doing them by hand. The full checklist is `docs/centre-setup.md` in the ExamEye folder.

Step 1: Install

- Copy the ExamEye folder somewhere permanent, for example `C:\ExamEye`. Moving or deleting it later switches the extension off.
- In Chrome open `chrome://extensions` and switch **Developer mode** on (top right). Three buttons appear.
- Click **Load unpacked** and choose the ExamEye folder. ExamEye appears in the list with its toggle on.
- Leave Developer mode on. If Chrome ever shows a "Disable developer mode extensions" bubble, click Cancel: its Disable button would switch ExamEye off.
- Microsoft Edge works the same way at `edge://extensions`.



`chrome://extensions` with Developer mode on: Load unpacked is the first button.



ExamEye loaded and enabled.

Step 2: Allow in Incognito

`chrome://extensions` → ExamEye → Details → **Allow in Incognito**: on. Without this a private window is invisible to ExamEye, and an incognito window opened during the paper is never recorded.

Step 3: Chrome must not ask where to save

Chrome Settings → Downloads → "Ask where to save each file before downloading": **off**. Otherwise every screenshot and log file would pop up a save dialog. Note the download location shown there: the recordings go into an `ExamEye` folder inside it.

macOS only. System Settings → Privacy & Security → Screen Recording → enable Chrome, then quit and reopen Chrome. Without it, whole-screen pictures come out black and nothing warns you. Windows needs nothing here.

Also add the exam site to Chrome's "Always keep these sites active" list (Settings → Performance), so a sleeping tab does not look like the candidate left.

Step 4: Configure

Right-click the ExamEye icon in the toolbar and choose **Options**. The page has five short sections; every field has a one-line explanation under it. The values for a given exam platform are usually worked out once and copied to every machine.

SECTION	WHAT GOES THERE
1. Exam website	The start page address, and the result page address if the platform has one.
2. How the paper starts and ends	The text of the submit button (use the confirm button's text if the platform asks "Are you sure?"), or a phrase that appears only on the "submitted" screen. The maximum paper length is a backstop.
3. This machine	A seat or centre ID that goes into every folder name, and the folder name under Downloads.
4. Recording	How often to take a routine screenshot, and how long to wait before giving up on a paper whose tab has disappeared. The defaults are fine.
5. Screen capture	Whole-screen pictures on or off, and how often to ask again if the candidate refuses to share.

ExamEye setup

Fill in the five sections once per machine, then click Save. Recording starts and stops on its own when a paper opens.

1 Exam website

Which web addresses belong to the exam. ExamEye starts when the start page opens and treats everything on the same site as part of the paper.

Exam start page

http://127.0.0.1:64950/exam/start.html

The address every candidate lands on first, up to but not including the part that differs per candidate.

Paper pages (optional)

leave blank to use the start page's site

Only needed when the questions are served from a different address than the start page.

Result page (optional)

http://127.0.0.1:64950/exam/result.html

The address shown once the paper is submitted. Can be left blank when a submit button or a submitted-screen phrase is set in section 2.

2 How the paper starts and ends

ExamEye needs one way to notice the end of the paper: a submit button, a phrase on the "submitted" screen, or the result page above.

Start button label (optional)

e.g. Start test

The exact text on the button that starts the paper, for platforms where the page address does not change. Leave blank to start recording as soon as the start page opens.

Submit button label(s) (optional)

Finish, Confirm submission

The text on the button that finishes the paper. If the platform asks "Are you sure?", use the text of that confirm button. Separate several with commas.

Submitted-screen phrase (optional)

e.g. Your answers have been submitted

A sentence that appears only on the "your answers have been submitted" screen and nowhere else in the paper.

Maximum paper length (minutes)

200

Keep watching after submit (minutes)

5

A backupstop: the recording ends this long after it

How long to keep recording after the paper is

3 This machine

How the recordings from this desk are named and where they are kept.

Seat or centre ID

C12-S07

Folder name under Downloads

ExamEye

Goes into every folder name so a recording can be matched to this desk.

All recordings go into this folder inside Chrome's download location, one sub-folder per paper.

4 Recording

Screenshots are taken whenever something happens (a tab switch, a copy, a window change) and at a routine interval.

Routine screenshot every (minutes)

10

Give up after the exam tab is gone for (minutes)

10

A picture of the exam tab at this interval, on top of the ones taken when something happens.

If the exam tab is closed and does not come back within this time, the paper is closed as abandoned.

5 Screen capture

Besides the exam tab, ExamEye can photograph the whole screen while the candidate is away from Chrome. The candidate is asked once per paper to share their screen.

Capture the whole screen when the candidate leaves Chrome

Off

Frames are taken only while Chrome is not the active window and at each routine screenshot. Set to Off only where the centre forbids screen recording.

Ask again after a refusal (minutes)

5

If the candidate cancels the share dialog, ask again after this long. 0 asks only once.

Save settings

Recordings are saved in <Chrome download folder>/ExamEye/<date-time_seat>/

Sections 1 and 2: the exam website and how the paper starts and ends.

Sections 3 to 5: this machine, recording, screen capture, and the Save bar.

The page tells you what to fix

A problem is shown in red directly under the field it belongs to. Nothing is saved until every problem is cleared; the Save bar counts the fields still to fix, and a green "Saved." confirms the settings are stored.

ExamEye setup

Fill in the five sections once per machine, then click Save. Recording starts and stops on its own when a paper opens.

1 Exam website

Which web addresses belong to the exam. ExamEye starts when the start page opens and treats everything on the same site as part of the paper.

Exam start page

exam.example.com/start

must be an http(s) URL prefix

Paper pages (optional)

leave blank to use the start page's site

Only needed when the questions are served from a different address than the start page.

Result page (optional)

http://127.0.0.1:64950/exam/result.html

The address shown once the paper is submitted. Can be left blank when a submit button or a submitted-screen phrase is set in section 2.

2 How the paper starts and ends

ExamEye needs one way to notice the end of the paper: a submit button, a phrase on the

An address without http(s) is refused under the field itself.

If a paper is being recorded on the machine, an orange notice appears at the top. Any change saved then is written into that paper's log with the names of the fields changed, and the folder for the paper in progress does not move. A settings change during a paper can never be silent.

ExamEye setup

Fill in the five sections once per machine, then click Save. Recording starts and stops on its own when a paper opens.

A paper is being recorded on this machine right now.
 Anything you save here is written into that paper's log, with the names of the fields you changed.
 The folder for the paper in progress does not change.

1 Exam website
 Which web addresses belong to the exam. ExamEye starts when the start page opens and treats everything on the same site as part of the paper.

Exam start page

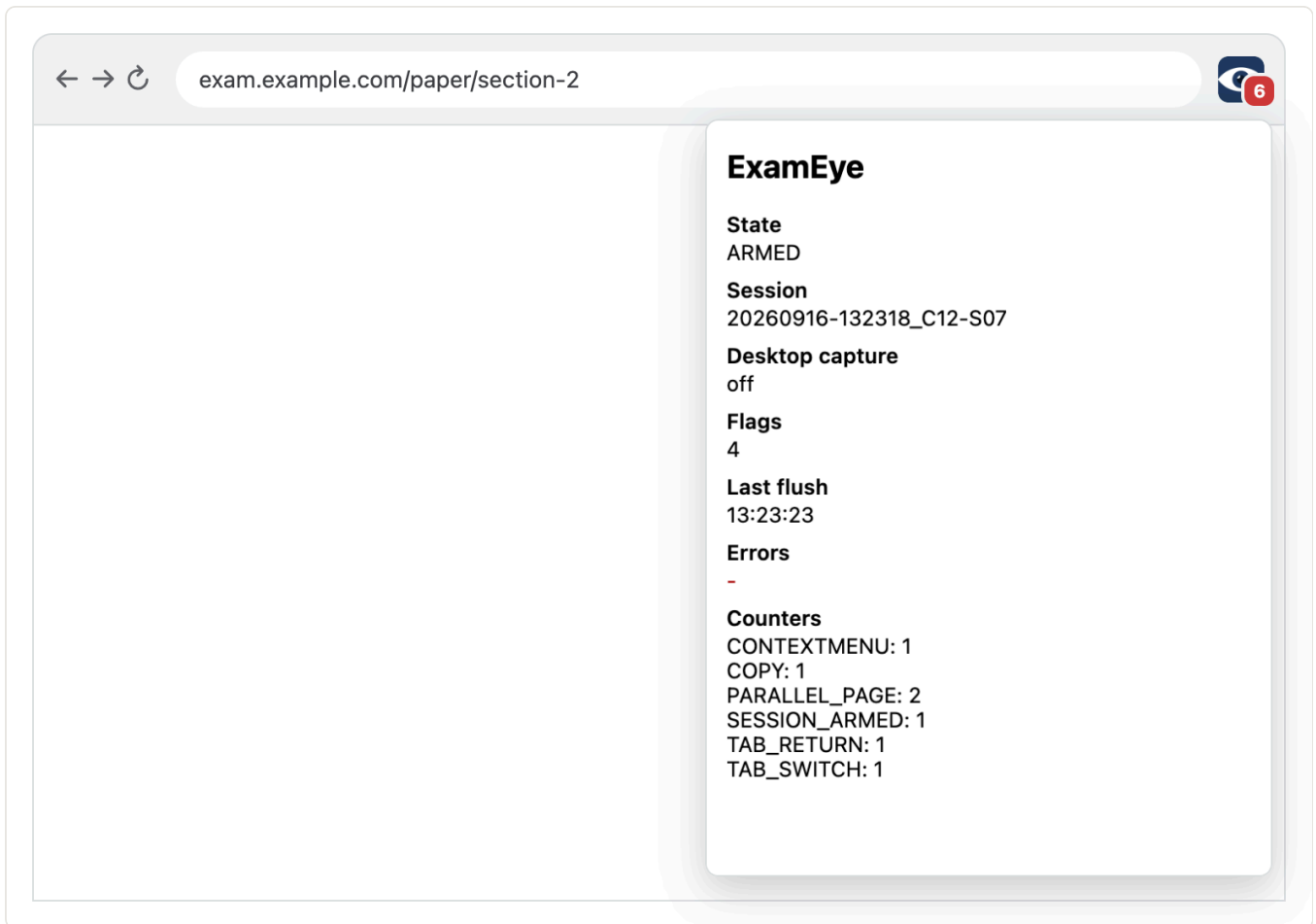
The address every candidate lands on first, up to but not including the part that differs per candidate.

The notice shown while a paper is being recorded.

Step 5: Dry run

Ten minutes with a throw-away test login. Do it on the day, on every machine.

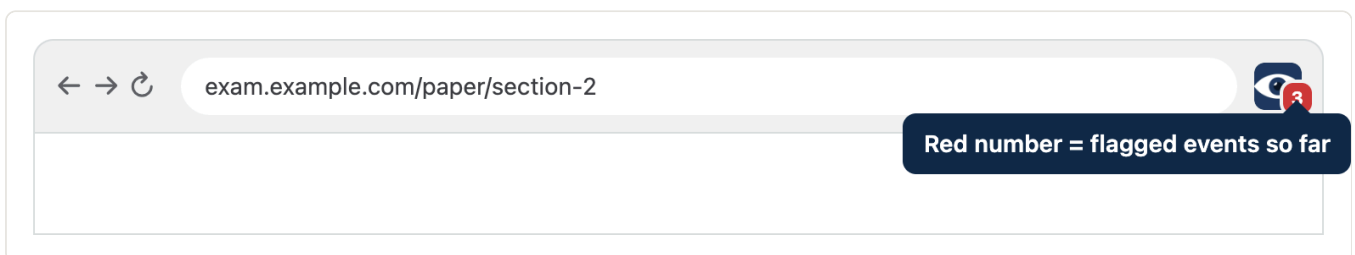
DO	EXPECT
Open the exam start page	The ExamEye icon shows a red 0. Click it: the popup says ARMED with a session id.
Open another tab, then come back	The popup's Counters show <code>TAB_SWITCH: 1</code> ; the badge shows 1.
Minimise the window and restore it	Counters show <code>WINDOW_MINIMIZED: 1</code> .
Lock the screen or wait for the screensaver, then unlock	Counters show <code>SCREENSAVER: 1</code> .
Submit the test paper, or open the result page	State returns to IDLE and the badge disappears (after the post-submit minutes, if set).
Look in Downloads → ExamEye	One folder named with the date, time and seat ID, containing <code>log.txt</code> , <code>summary.html</code> and a <code>screenshots</code> folder.



The popup during the dry run: State ARMED, the session id, and the live counters.

5. On exam day

Nothing to start. Glance at the toolbar icon; click it for detail.

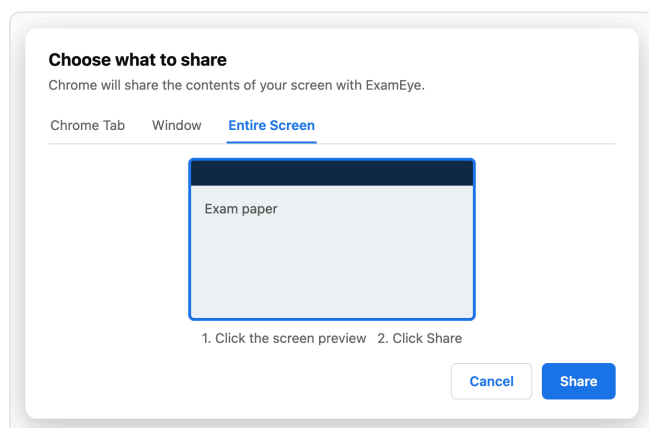


The red number on the icon is the count of flagged events so far. A red 0 means recording is on and nothing has been flagged.

POPUP LINE	MEANING
State	ARMED : recording. CLOSING : the paper was submitted and the last minutes are still being watched. IDLE : no paper is open.
Session	The date, time and seat ID that name the output folder.
Desktop capture	Whether whole-screen pictures are being taken, since when, and how many.
Flags	The same number as the badge.
Last flush	When files were last written to disk; it updates every 30 seconds while recording.
Errors	Normally a dash. Anything else names the setting or file that failed; a link opens the setup page.
Counters	Every event type seen so far, with its count.

Screen capture: the one thing the candidate does

When the start page opens, a small "ExamEye screen capture" window appears and Chrome shows its share dialog. The candidate clicks the screen preview, then **Share** (Chrome only enables Share after the preview is clicked). The small window then minimises itself. It must stay open: closing it stops capture, and that is logged.



ExamEye records the screen during this paper. In Chrome's dialog, click the screen preview, then **Share**.

The small ExamEye window that keeps the capture alive.

Chrome's share dialog (illustration): click the preview, then Share.

Whole-screen pictures are taken while Chrome is not the active window and at each routine screenshot. If the candidate cancels, that is logged and the question is asked again after five minutes (adjustable). With two screens only the shared one is captured and the paper is flagged `MULTI_MONITOR`. On macOS the pictures are black unless Chrome has the Screen Recording permission (step 3); check one during the dry run.

6. What you get

One folder per paper under Downloads → ExamEye, named with the date, time and seat ID. Open `summary.html` in any browser; it is self-contained, with the screenshots embedded, so the single file can be copied or emailed on its own.

FILE	WHAT IT IS
summary.html	The report: outcome, flags, time away, parallel pages, the full timeline, every screenshot.
summary.txt	The same report as plain text.
log.txt	One line per event, each carrying a fingerprint of the line before it.
events.json	The same events in a form other software can read.
screenshots/	Exam-tab pictures, named by time and event.
screenshots/desktop/	Whole-screen pictures, when capture is on.

ExamEye 20260916-173512_C12-S07 Seat C12-S07
 ✓ RESULT ✓ Log chain OK (12 lines)

STARTED
2026-09-16
17:35:12
+05:30

ENDED
2026-09-16
17:36:25
result URL
http://127.0.0.1:64950/exam/res
reached at 17:36:25
(auto-submit expected at
20:55:12)

DURATION
00:01:13

SCREENSHOTS
4 tab / 0
desktop
4 files

DESKTOP CAPTURE
off

EVENTS
11
10 kinds

FLAGS

PARALLEL PAGES
2 × critical

TAB SWITCHES
1 ▲ warning

COPY
1 ● serious

TIME AWAY

Tab away		00:00:02
Focus left Chrome (user)		00:00:00
Window minimised		00:00:00
Screensaver / lock		00:00:00
Idle		00:00:11

Focus-left episodes attributed to: user 0, screensaver 0, idle 0 (only user time is counted above)

PHASES

PHASE	SPAN	DURATION	SCREENSHOTS
Exam	17:35:12 - 17:36:25	00:01:13	4 screenshots

PARALLEL PAGES

FOCUSED	VISITS	URL	TITLE	INCOGNITO
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The top of summary.html: outcome, log chain, flags with severity colours, time away.

Reading the report

- **Outcome and log chain.** RESULT, SUBMITTED, AUTO_SUBMITTED, TIMED_OUT or ABANDONED. "Log chain OK" means no line of the log was altered afterwards.
- **Flags.** Each flagged event type with its count and a colour: red critical, orange serious, yellow warning.
- **Time away.** How long the exam tab was not in front, Chrome was not the active application, the window was minimised, the screen was locked.
- **Parallel pages.** Every other page visited during the paper, with focused time and visits.

- **Timeline and screenshots.** Every event in order; the "tab" and "desktop" links open the picture taken at that moment.

For a dispute, start with the flags, then use the timeline links to see the screenshot at each flagged moment.

#	TIME	EVENT	DETAILS	SHOTS
1	17:35:12	SESSION_ARMED	trigger nav url http://127.0.0.1:64950/exam/start.html?candidate=1	tab
2	17:35:12	CONTEXTMENU	tag H1	tab
3	17:35:15	PARALLEL_PAGE	incognito false trigger committed url http://127.0.0.1:64950/other.html	
4	17:35:15	TAB_SWITCH	incognito false toTabId 208374785 toTitle Other page toUrl http://127.0.0.1:64950/other.html toWindowId 208374776	tab
5	17:35:15	PARALLEL_PAGE	incognito false title Other page trigger activated url http://127.0.0.1:64950/other.html	tab
6	17:35:17	TAB_RETURN	awayMs 2720	
7	17:35:17	COPY	len 0	tab
8	17:36:09	IDLE_START	state idle	
9	17:36:20	IDLE_END	idleMs 11009	
10	17:36:25	RESULT_PAGE	url http://127.0.0.1:64950/exam/result.html	tab
11	17:36:25	SESSION_DISARMED	outcome RESULT trigger result url http://127.0.0.1:64950/exam/result.html	tab

The timeline: every event in order, with a link to the picture taken at that moment.

7. Flags and what they mean

The same list drives the red badge, the popup and the report. Severity is a reading aid, not a verdict: one tab switch can be innocent; five parallel pages during a closed-book paper usually are not.

FLAG	MEANING	SEVERITY
Parallel pages	Another web page was used	 critical
Incognito windows	A private window was opened	 critical
DevTools	The browser inspector was opened	 critical
Config changed	ExamEye settings were changed mid-paper	 critical
Clock set back	The computer clock jumped backwards	 critical
Copy, Cut, Paste	Clipboard use on the exam page	 serious
Print	The print dialog was opened	 serious
Drag out	Content dragged out of the exam page	 serious
Downloads	A file was downloaded	 serious
Recording gaps	ExamEye was not running for a while	 serious
Tab switches	Another tab came in front	 warning
Left Chrome	Another application came in front	 warning
Window minimised	The exam window was minimised	 warning
Fullscreen exits	The paper left full-screen mode	 warning
Screensaver / lock	The screen locked or the screensaver ran	 warning
Multiple screens	More than one monitor was attached	 warning

8. Can the record be trusted?

Every log line carries a fingerprint of the line before it. Change one line and everything after it breaks. The report's "Log chain OK" badge shows the log is intact from first line to last; a period when ExamEye was switched off shows as a Recording gap with its length; and every screenshot named in the log must be present in the folder. It cannot prove who was at the keyboard. That is the invigilator's job.

IT can re-check any folder later, independently of the report, with one command run from the ExamEye folder (it needs Node.js on that machine):

```
node tools/verify.mjs "<folder>"
```

```
OK 20260916-173512_C12-S07: 12 lines, 11 events, 4 screenshots present
```

A modified copy reports **BROKEN** and names the first bad line or the missing picture.

9. Limits and privacy



A candidate can switch the extension off. On an unmanaged machine nothing prevents it. The switch-off appears as a Recording gap, and a paper with missing files is itself evidence. Managed machines can lock it by policy.



It sees only the browser. Phones, paper notes and a second computer are invisible. Whole-screen capture shows other applications only while Chrome is not in front, and only if the candidate accepted the share.



The settings page is open to anyone at the machine. That is why every change during a paper is logged with a screenshot, and why the output folder is fixed when the paper starts.



Nothing leaves the machine. ExamEye has no server. Files are written to the local Downloads folder and stay there until the centre collects them. Candidates should be told they are being recorded; a notice template is in the setup checklist.

10. Exam-day checklist

- ExamEye shows as enabled at `chrome://extensions` .
- Chrome does not ask where to save downloads.
- Settings saved for today's paper; the seat ID is this desk.
- Dry run done on this machine today.
- Extra monitors disconnected; the screen-share prompt explained to candidates.
- After the paper: copy the session folder from Downloads → ExamEye.